

λ -terms are in β -normal form if they contain no redexes.

$$\text{is_in_nf}(M) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \forall M'. M \not\rightarrow_{\beta} M'$$

$$\text{has_nf}(M) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \exists M'. M \rightarrow_{\beta}^* M' \wedge \text{is_in_nf}(M')$$

THEOREM (UNIQUENESS OF β -NORMAL FORMS)

$$\forall M, N_1, N_2. M \rightarrow_{\beta}^* N_1 \wedge M \rightarrow_{\beta}^* N_2 \wedge$$

$$\text{is_in_nf}(N_1) \wedge \text{is_in_nf}(N_2) \implies N_1 =_{\alpha} N_2$$

PROOF. From Church-Rosser, obtain N , such that $N_1 \rightarrow_{\beta}^* N$ and $N_2 \rightarrow_{\beta}^* N$. However, since N_1 and N_2 are in normal form, we have that $N_1 =_{\alpha} N =_{\alpha} N_2$.